Zaply Recorder on TrueNAS SCALE

Install, connect to Zaply, update · about 10 minutes

Zaply Recorder records live TV and downloads films and series for Zaply on iPhone, iPad and Apple TV. On a NAS it runs as a TrueNAS app, always on, with your recordings in a dataset you can share with your computers.

What you need

- TrueNAS SCALE **24.10 (Electric Eel) or later**, where apps run on Docker.
- The NAS on the same network as your iPhone, iPad or Apple TV.
- Zaply on an iPhone or iPad, signed in as the household's owner: the owner sets the recorder up.

In the examples, `tank` is the pool and `tank/media` the dataset shared with your computers. Use your own names: the paths follow them.

1 Make a dataset for the recordings

Recordings and downloads go in a dataset of their own, so you can open them from your computers and keep them if you ever remove the app. The recorder's settings need no dataset: TrueNAS makes one by itself in step 2.

1. Open **Datasets** and select the dataset to put it in, for example `tank/media`, one you share with your computers.
2. Click **Add Dataset**.
3. Fill it in:

Field	Value
Parent Path	`tank/media` (already filled in)
Name	`Zaply`
Dataset Preset	**SMB** if the parent is shared over SMB, so recordings can be opened and deleted from a Mac or PC. Otherwise **Generic**.

4. Click **Save**. Its path on the NAS is `/mnt/tank/media/Zaply`: `/mnt/` followed by the dataset's full name. Select the dataset to see it in its details.

2 Install the app

Open **Apps** ▸ **Discover Apps** and click **Custom App** at the top right. Fill in only these fields; leave every other one as it is.

Field	Value
At the top	
Application Name	`zaply-recorder`
Image Configuration	
Repository	`ghcr.io/goodfolks-app/zaply-recorder`
Tag	`latest`
Container Configuration	
Timezone	Your own, picked in the list
Restart Policy	Unless Stopped
Network Configuration	
Host Network	**Ticked**: Zaply then finds the recorder by itself

Storage Configuration: two entries

Click **Add** next to Storage once for each.

Field	Entry 1: its settings	Entry 2: the recordings
Type	**ixVolume** (Dataset created automatically by the system)	**Host Path** (Path that already exists on the system)
Read Only	unticked	unticked
Mount Path	`/data`	`/library`
Enable ACL	unticked	unticked
Dataset Name	`data` (replace `storage_entry`)	–
Host Path	–	`/mnt/tank/media/Zaply`, picked in the list

> **Mount Path and Host Path are not the same thing**
> The **Mount Path** is the folder as the recorder sees it, always `/data` or `/library`. The **Host Path** is the folder on the NAS, starting with `/mnt/`. A `/mnt/…` path in Mount Path is the usual mistake.

Click **Install**. Within a minute, **Apps** ▸ **Installed** shows **zaply-recorder** as **Running**.

3 Open its page and set a password

1. In a browser, open `http://<the NAS's address>:9393`: the address of TrueNAS's own page, with `:9393` at the end. For example `http://192.168.1.20:9393`.
2. Go to **Settings**. Give it a **Name**, for example *NAS* (otherwise it's named after the NAS), and a **Password**. Click **Save and restart**: it's back within a few seconds.

The library folder shows `/library` and can't be changed there: TrueNAS sets it, through the storage in step 2.

4 Add it in Zaply

On an iPhone or iPad, as the household's owner:

1. Open **Settings ▸ Zaply Recorder**.
2. If another recorder is set up, the Mac app for example, scroll down and tap **Remove the recorder** first.
3. Tap **Set up your recorder**, pick the NAS by its name, and type its password.

Everyone in the household then sees it on their own devices, Apple TV included. To record, use **Record** on a channel or in the TV guide, **Record every airing**, or **Record the match**. For a film or an episode, use **Download to the recorder**.

> **The NAS isn't listed?**
> Check that Host Network is ticked (Apps ▸ Installed ▸ zaply-recorder ▸ Edit). You can also type its address in the set-up sheet: `http://<the NAS's address>:9393`.

5 Away from home (optional)

At home, Zaply talks to the recorder directly. To schedule and watch from elsewhere, choose one way:

- **Tailscale** (recommended): run Tailscale on the NAS (TrueNAS has a Tailscale app in Discover Apps) and on your iPhone. In Zaply, **Settings ▸ Zaply Recorder ▸ Address away from home**: `http://<the NAS's Tailscale address>:9393`. Nothing is exposed to the internet.
- **Port forwarding**: on your router, forward port **9394** to the NAS, and only that one, never 9393. In Zaply, set Address away from home to `https://<your home's public address>:9394`. Open Zaply once at home first, so it learns the recorder's certificate.

6 Update

TrueNAS checks for a new version by itself, every now and then. When **Apps ▸ Installed** shows **Update available** for zaply-recorder, select it and click **Update**.

To update right away instead: select zaply-recorder, click **Edit**, set **Pull Policy** (Image Configuration) to **Always pull**, and **Save**. TrueNAS starts it again with the newest version. Then set the Pull Policy back to its default, so the app also starts when the NAS has no internet.

Either way, the settings and recordings stay, and a recording in progress resumes in the same file.

7 Where things are

What	Where
Recordings	The `Zaply` dataset: `Live TV`, `Movies` and `Series` folders, one file per recording. Plex, Jellyfin and Emby can read them as they are.
Its settings	The ixVolume TrueNAS made (`data`).
Its page	`http://<the NAS's address>:9393`: what's recording, the schedule, the library, the logs, the settings.
Its log	On its page, under **Logs**, or in TrueNAS: Apps ▸ Installed ▸ zaply-recorder ▸ Workloads ▸ the logs icon.
Ports	**9393**: its page and the Zaply apps. **9394**: HTTPS, only for a port forwarded from the internet. Both must be free on the NAS.

8 If something goes wrong

What you see	What to do
Install refuses the Host Path	The `Zaply` dataset must exist (step 1), and the Host Path must start with `/mnt/`. You can make the dataset from the path list: select its parent, then **Create Dataset**.
The app doesn't reach Running	Open its log (Apps ▸ Installed ▸ zaply-recorder ▸ Workloads ▸ logs icon): it says why.
Its page doesn't open	Check the address ends with `:9393` and starts with `http://`, not https.
Zaply doesn't find it	Host Network must be ticked. Otherwise type its address in the set-up sheet.
Recordings can't be deleted from a Mac or PC	The dataset needs the SMB preset (step 1), or permissions that let your user change files written by the app.

Removing it

Apps ▸ Installed ▸ zaply-recorder ▸ **Delete**. With **Remove ixVolumes** ticked, its settings and list of recordings go too. The recordings themselves stay in the `Zaply` dataset.

Zaply is a media player. It does not provide, host, index or recommend any content. Users are solely responsible for the content they access and for complying with the laws that apply to them.